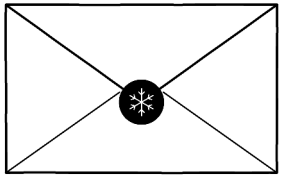
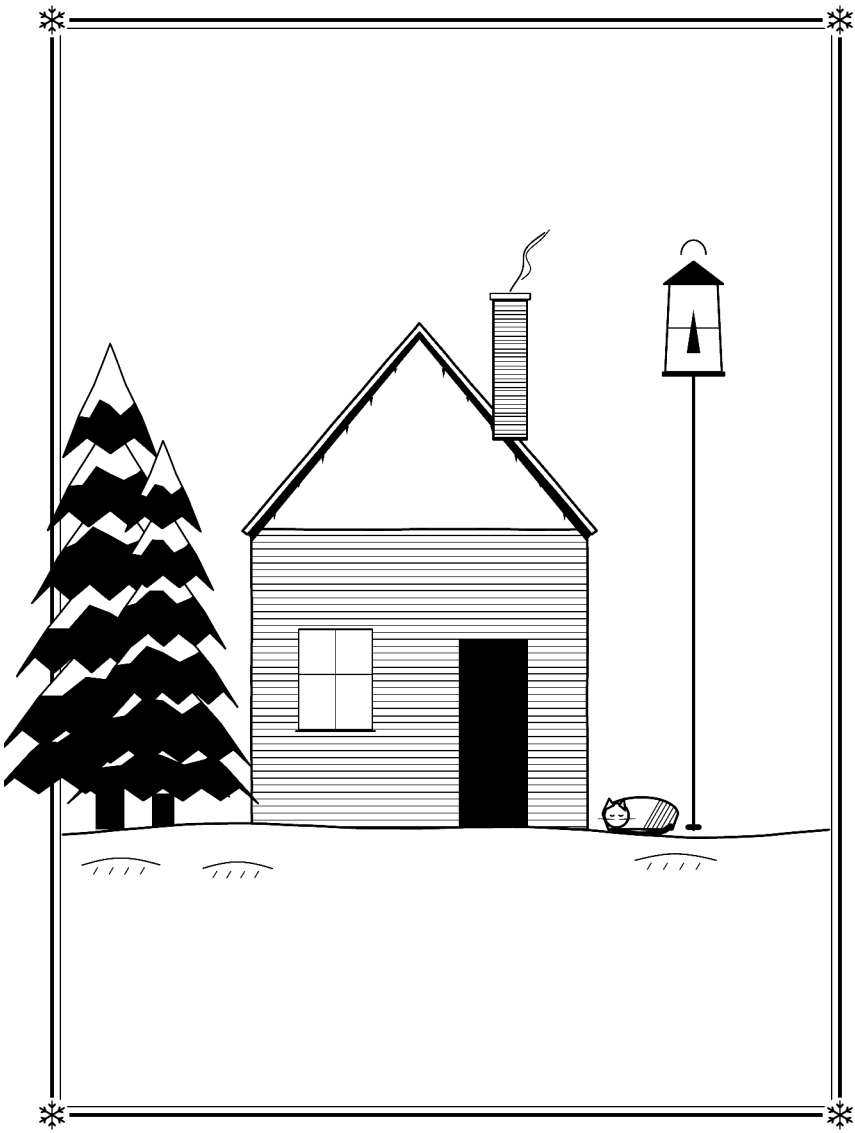
STORIES WE KEEP





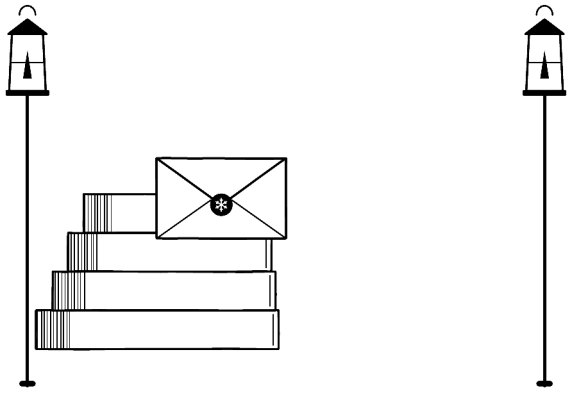
A house, a lamp, and stories waiting to be written

A GUIDED MEMORY KEEPSAKE

STORIES WE KEEP

A Guided Memory Keepsake for the Ones We Love

Writing prompts for parents and grandparents



Blake La Pierre

Stories We Keep

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This is a guided keepsake journal. The prompts and illustrations are original to this edition.

No ISBN on this page — KDP provides a free ISBN and prints the barcode on the back cover.

Printed in the United States of America.
First edition.

How This Book Works

This book is a gift you give to someone whose stories you want to keep — a parent, a grandparent, an aunt, an uncle, a dear friend. Or it is a gift you give yourself, so the people who love you will have your voice on paper.

• Write in ink or pencil. There is no wrong answer and no perfect length.

• Skip what you like. Circle back later. Cross things out. Paste a photo in the margins if you want.

• Use the lined pages at the back when a story needs more room.

• The letter pages near the end are for notes to children, grandchildren, or the person who gave you this book.

• Take your time. A page a week is enough. This book is meant to last.

When it is finished, it becomes a family heirloom: handwriting, memories, and a little ink art of home.

This Book Belongs To

Name

Given by

Date

For the family of

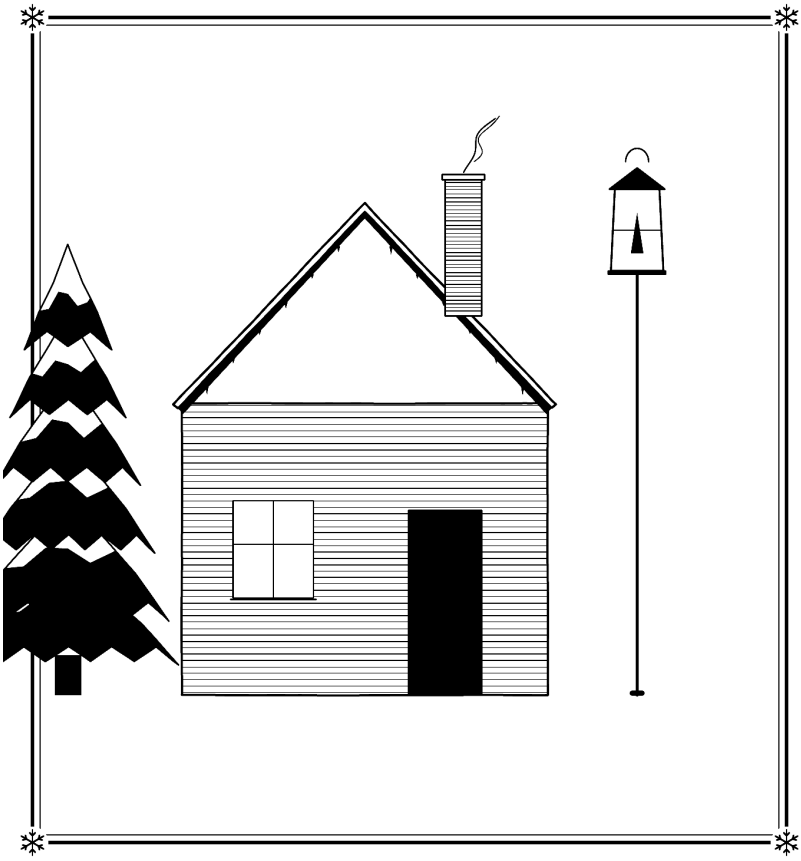
Contents

How This Book Works
This Book Belongs To
Part One: Beginnings
Part Two: Childhood Days
Part Three: Growing Up
Part Four: Love and Family
Part Five: Work and Days
Part Six: Holidays and Traditions
Part Seven: Favorites
Part Eight: Wisdom and Letters
Family Tree
A Simple Timeline
Extra Pages
A Note of Thanks

PART ONE

BEGINNINGS

Where a life starts: a name, a place, a first house and the people who waited for you.



Your full name

Write your full name, and any nicknames you have been called.

When and where you were born

Date, town or city, and anything you know about the day.

Your parents

Their names, and a few words about who they were.



BROTHERS AND SISTERS

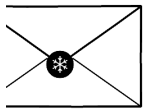
Who else grew up with you? What were they like?

The house you first remember

Describe the house, the street, the town — even a single room.

A SMELL, A SOUND, A SEASON FROM EARLY CHILDHOOD

Anything that still brings that time back.



WHO LOOKED AFTER YOU

Grandparents, neighbors, aunts, uncles — anyone who helped raise you.

A TREASURED EARLY MEMORY

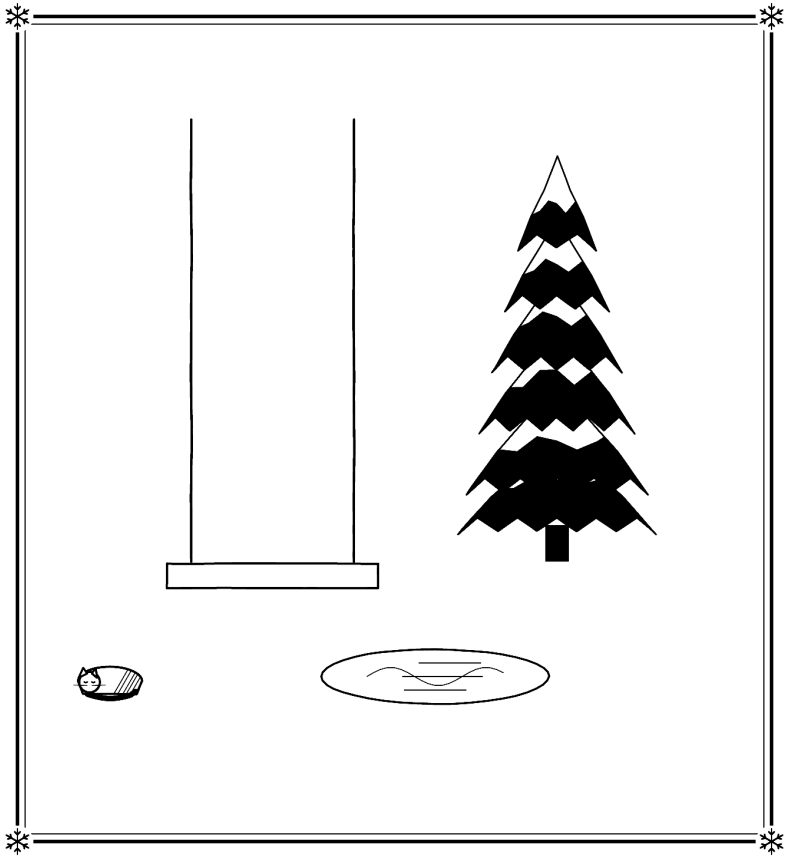
One small story from before you started school.



PART TWO

CHILDHOOD DAYS

School bells, backyard games, pets, chores and the first friends who mattered.



SCHOOL DAYS

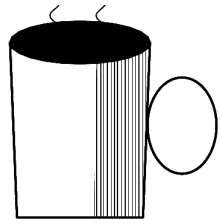
Where did you go to school? Favourite subject? A teacher you still remember?

GAMES AND PLAY

What did you play after school or in the summer?

PETS AND ANIMALS

Any pets, farm animals or creatures you loved?



CHORES AND POCKET MONEY

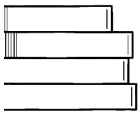
What were you expected to do around the house?

Best friend

Who was your closest friend growing up, and what did you do together?

A FAVORITE PLACE NEARBY

A park, a shop, a creek, a library — somewhere you returned to.



Something you collected or made

Stamps, comics, models, sewing, drawings...

A LESSON FROM CHILDHOOD

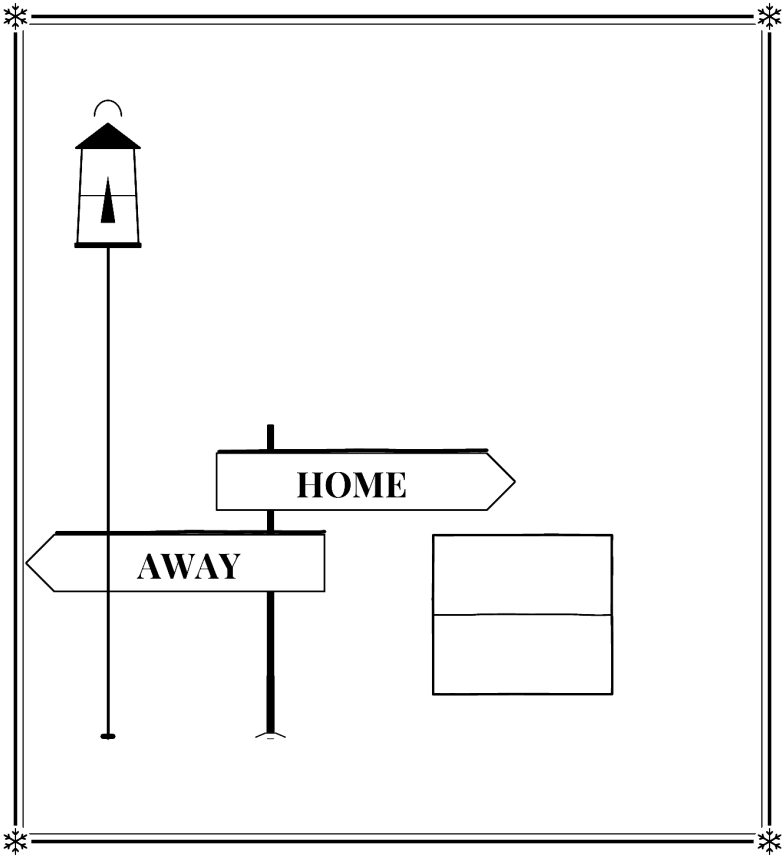
Something you learned the hard way, or the gentle way.



PART THREE

GROWING UP

Teenage years, first jobs, leaving home, and the dreams you carried forward.



AS A TEENAGER

What were you like? Music, clothes, hobbies, opinions.

First job

Where did you work, and what did you learn?

LEAVING HOME

When and why did you leave? How did it feel?



A PLACE YOU LIVED ON YOUR OWN

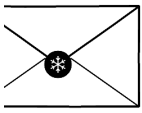
Describe a room or flat from those years.

Someone who influenced you

A mentor, relative, friend or public figure.

A TRIP OR ADVENTURE

A journey that changed how you saw the world.



A DREAM YOU HAD THEN

What did you hope your life would look like?

Advice you would give your younger self

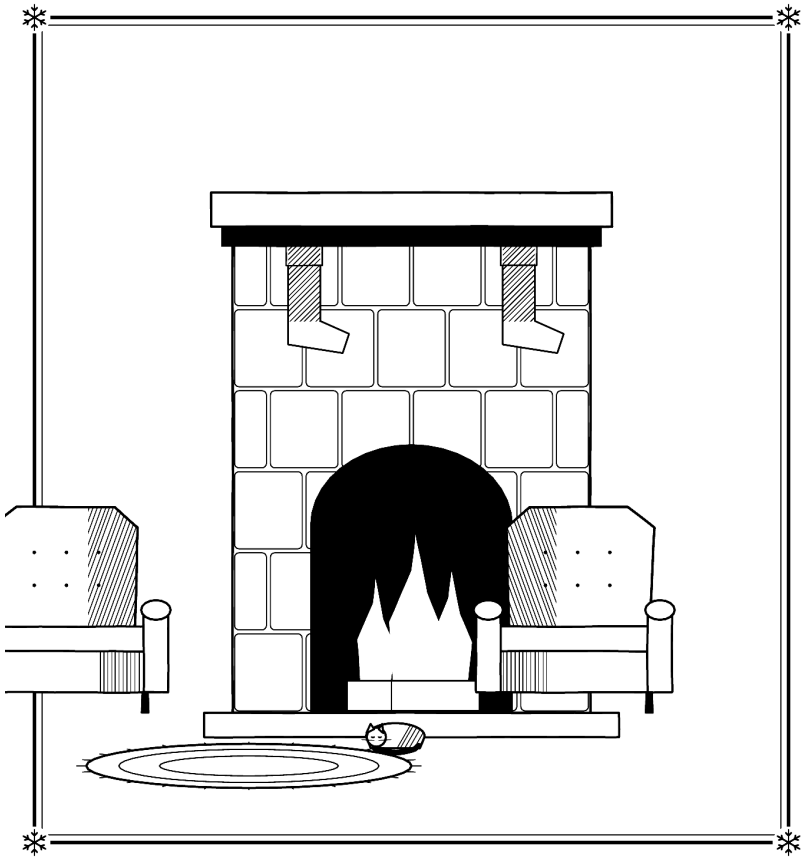
A few kind, honest lines.



PART FOUR

LOVE AND FAMILY

Meeting someone, building a home, becoming a parent or grandparent — the heart of the story.



How you met

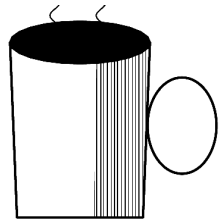
The person you built a life with — or a great love of your life.

A WEDDING DAY OR COMMITMENT

Where, when, what you remember most.

MAKING A HOME TOGETHER

The first place that felt like yours.



Becoming a parent

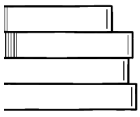
The day a child arrived, and how it changed you.

Everyday family life

Meals, evenings, weekends — the ordinary that mattered.

Becoming a grandparent

If you are one: the first news, the first visit, the feeling.



Family traditions you started

Something small you hope continues.

WHAT FAMILY MEANS TO YOU

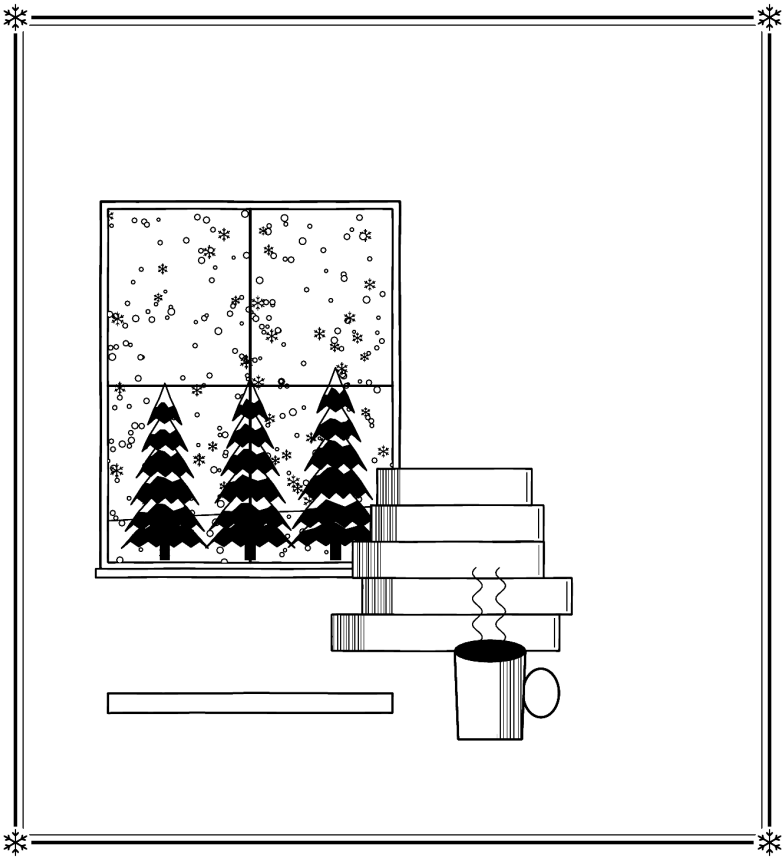
In your own words.



PART FIVE

WORK AND DAYS

The work of your hands and mind, the towns you lived in, and how the world changed around you.



Your work

Jobs, trades, callings — what filled your weekdays.

A PROUD DAY AT WORK

Something you finished, fixed, taught or built.

Places you have lived

List the towns or cities, with a note for each.



How the world changed

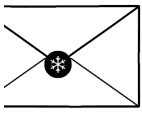
Technology, manners, money, news — what surprised you.

Hard times

A season that tested you, and what helped.

A SKILL YOU ARE GLAD YOU LEARNED

Cooking, mending, numbers, music, languages...



Community and neighbors

Clubs, church, volunteers, the street you knew.

Retirement or slowing down

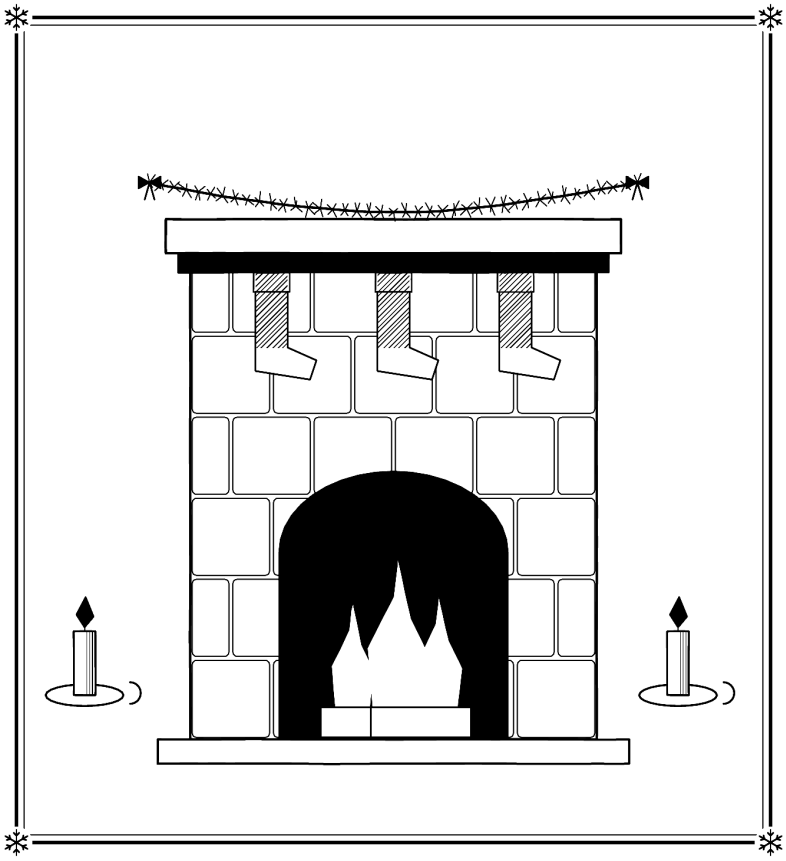
If it applies — how you spend the quieter years.



PART SIX

HOLIDAYS AND TRADITIONS

Feasts, birthdays, seasons and the little rituals that make a house feel like home.



A FAVORITE HOLIDAY

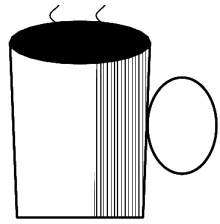
Which one, and why?

How your family celebrated

Food, guests, music, decorations.

A BIRTHDAY YOU REMEMBER

Yours or someone else's.



Recipes that mean home

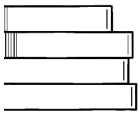
Dishes that appear every year — and who cooks them.

A GIFT YOU NEVER FORGOT

Given or received.

Seasonal rituals

Spring cleaning, summer trips, autumn walks, winter evenings.



Songs and stories at gatherings

What always gets told or sung?

A TRADITION YOU WANT PASSED ON

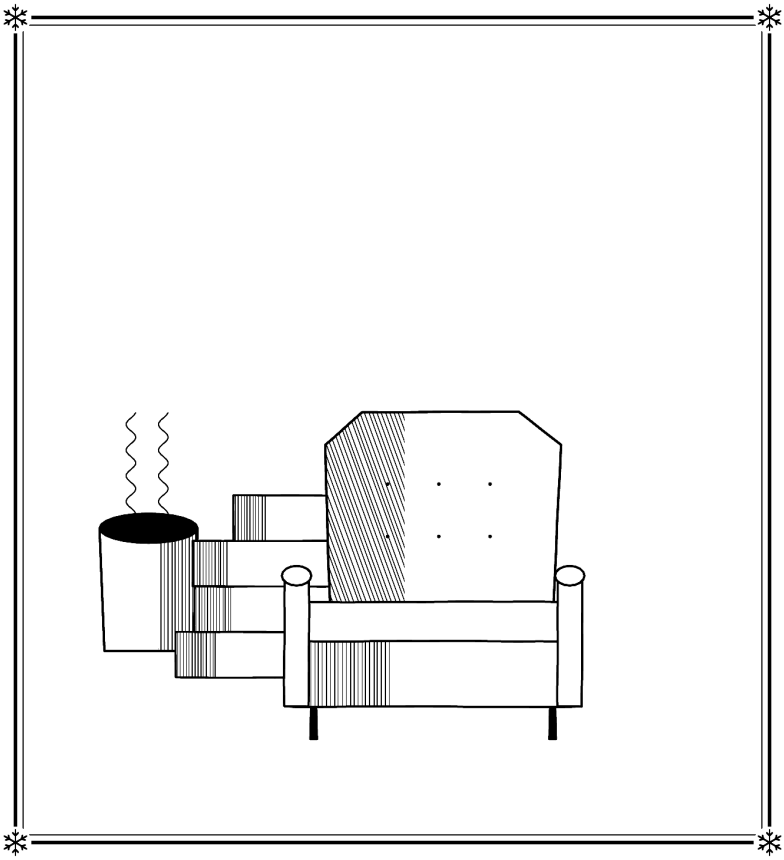
Write it clearly so someone can keep it.



PART SEVEN

FAVORITES

The small loves that paint a portrait: books, meals, places, sayings and simple pleasures.



Favourite meal

What and where — and who usually made it.

FAVOURITE BOOK, FILM OR SONG

Pick one of each if you like.

Favourite place outdoors

Garden, shore, mountain, park, porch...



Favourite season and weather

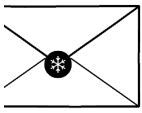
And what you do in it.

A SAYING YOU LIVE BY

A proverb, a family phrase, a line you repeat.

Comforts

Tea, a chair, a walk, a radio programme — the quiet joys.



Things that make you laugh

People, jokes, habits, old stories.

Top five (anything)

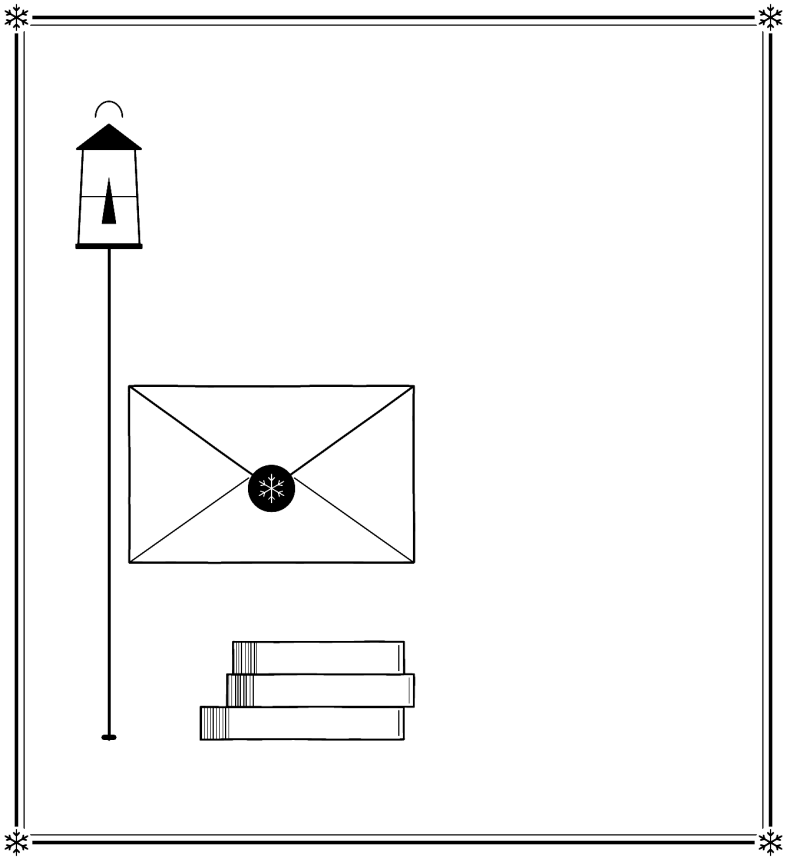
Fill a short list of five things you love — free choice.



PART EIGHT

WISDOM AND LETTERS

What you have learned, what you hope for the people who come after you, and letters you may leave behind.



Life lessons

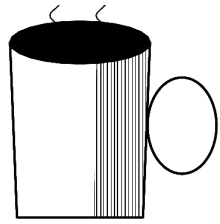
Three things experience taught you.

On love and friendship

Advice you would give.

ON WORK AND MONEY

What you wish someone had told you.



Hopes for the next generation

What you want for the children in your family.

How you want to be remembered

A few honest lines.

A LETTER TO YOUR CHILD OR CHILDREN

Write as if they will open this years from now.



A LETTER TO YOUR GRANDCHILD OR GRANDCHILDREN

Or to the young people who will read this.

A LETTER TO THE PERSON WHO GAVE YOU THIS BOOK

Thank them, tease them, tell them something true.

Anything else

Use these lines for a story that did not fit elsewhere.



ONE LAST PAGE

Whatever still wants saying.



Family Tree

Sketch your family tree here — parents, siblings, children, grandchildren. Use the facing page for more names.

name

name

name

name

name

name

name

name

MORE NAMES AND NOTES

A Simple Timeline

Mark a few milestones on this timeline: births, moves, marriages, jobs, journeys. Approximate years are fine.

Year _____ _____

Year _____ _____

Year _____ _____

Year _____ _____

Year _____ _____

Year _____ _____

Year _____ _____

Year _____ _____

Year _____ _____

Year _____ _____

Year _____ _____

Year _____ _____



Extra Pages

Extra lined pages for stories that need more room.

Thank You



For writing the stories we will keep.

Blake La Pierre